

# Mama Tried

**D** **G**  
The first thing I remember know-in'  
**D** **G**  
was a lonesome whist-le blow-in,  
**D** **G** **A**  
And a young-on's dream of grow-in up to ride,  
**D** **G**  
On a freight train leav-in town,  
**D** **G**  
not know-in where I'm bound,  
**D** **A** **D**  
And no one could change my mind, but Ma-ma tried.

**D** **G**  
One and on-ly reb-el child,  
**D** **G**  
From a fam-ily meek and mild,  
**D** **G** **A**  
My ma-ma seemed to know what lay in store,  
**D** **G**  
Spite all my Sun-day learn-in'  
**D** **G**  
towards the bad I kept on turn-in,  
**D** **A** **D**  
Til Ma-ma could-n't hold me an-y-more.

[Chorus]

**D** **G**  
And I turned twenty-one in pris-on do-in life with-out  
**D** **G** **D** **A**  
pa-role, No one could steer me right but Ma-ma tried,  
**D**  
Mama tried. Ma-ma tried to raise me bet-ter, but her  
**G** **D** **A**  
plead-ing I de-nied, That leaves only me to blame,  
**D**  
cause Ma-ma tried.